Appendix A

Taking the Java SE 17 and Java SE 11 Developer Exams

Please note that all information presented in this appendix is valid as of November 2024. It is imperative that readers regularly visit the websites mentioned in this appendix, as Oracle is known to change practical information regarding the exam and the exam objectives intermittently.

The primary focus of **Part II** is the *Java SE 17 Developer Exam* (*1Z0-829*) and the *Java SE 11 Developer Exam* (*1Z0-819*). Pertinent information about these two exams can be found here:

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https://education.oracle.com/java-se-17-developer/pexam_1Z0-829

https://education.oracle.com/java-se-11-developer/pexam_1Z0-819
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For authoritative information about the certification paths for Java SE, consult the following web page:

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https://education.oracle.com/oracle-certification-path/product_267
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Appendix B, **p. 1627**, and **Appendix C**, **p. 1633**, contain specific information about the objectives for the *Java SE 17 Developer* exam and the *Java SE 11 Developer* exam, respectively.

A.1 Preparing for the Exam

The goal of the exams is to test practical knowledge and usage of the Java programming language and specific APIs. The exams require a thorough understanding of both the syntax and the semantics of the language, including the use of its core APIs. The exams

cover a wide variety of topics, as defined in the exam objectives (**Appendix B**, **Appendix C**). Central to the exams are language constructs, usage of the core API, and specific topics, with heavy emphasis on interpreting code scenarios.

The need for real-world experience prior to taking the exam cannot be stressed enough. It requires very thorough preparation to pass the exam without having some actual Java programming experience. This book is intended to be used as a study guide: to encourage readers to try out what they have learned every step of the way, and to test their newly acquired knowledge using the review questions provided in every chapter.

Experimenting with the examples in this book will give the reader a much better chance of passing the exam. Numbered examples in the book are complete Java programs, the source code for which is available on the companion book website. Whether one uses the tools in the JDK or an IDE (integrated development environment), it is the hands-on programming that is important. That said, tools in the JDK are preferred as preparation for the exam, as there is less reliance on programming support provided by an IDE.

When the reader feels ready, they should test their skills on the mock exam for Java SE 17 provided in **Appendix E**. This will give the reader an indication of how well they are prepared for the exam, and which topics need further study. The structure of the book should make it easy for the reader to focus on single topics, if necessary.

The exam is considered to be difficult, and it requires a fair amount of studying on the part of the candidate. Even seasoned Java programmers should invest some time in preparing for the exam. Simply having real-world experience is not enough to pass the exam.

It is highly recommended that exam candidates devise a study plan, incorporating the activities we mentioned previously. Disruptions in the study plan should be avoided, as this can result in revising the material already covered when you pick up the thread. The exam should be scheduled immediately after the study period, when the momentum from the preparation is at its maximum.

We also highly recommend joining an online Java certification community, such as Code Ranch (**www.coderanch.com**), which has dedicated active forums for the different Java certifications. All things Java are discussed in a friendly manner around the bonfire at this ranch, where greenhorns are especially welcomed. The forum for Java Programmer Certification can be found here:

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https://coderanch.com/f/24/java-programmer-OCPJP

The following website provides more practice tests for OCP Java SE Developer certification at a nominal price:

Click here to view code image

https://enthuware.com/java-certification-mock-exams/oracle-certified-professional/ocp-java-17-exam-1z0-829

For answers to technical questions on Java, consult the following website:

https://stackoverflow.com

A.2 Registering for the Online Proctored Exam

The best way to find all pertinent up-to-date information for taking an exam is to visit the exam website, which provides all the relevant links on buying an exam, registering for the exam, and scheduling the exam.

A *certified Oracle account* is required to log on to the *Oracle CertView* certification portal, where pertinent information about the exam can be found. These steps can be accomplished at:

https://certview.oracle.com

Obtaining an Oracle Exam Attempt

An *exam attempt* (previously called a *certification voucher*) to take the exam is sold by Oracle.

Click here to view code image

https://education.oracle.com/buy-exam

Be sure to obtain an exam attempt for *Oracle Technology Exams*, which covers Java certification exams. Credit card information is usually required to arrange payment. The cost

of the exam attempt may vary depending on the country you live in and on any offers that might apply at the time. For US residents, the regular price is around $245 at the time of writing this book.

Note that the exam attempt has an expiration date, which is usually six months after it is acquired. Oracle will not replace lost or expired exam attempts, neither will they offer refunds for unused exam attempts.

Scheduling for the Online Proctored Exam

After obtaining the exam attempt, candidates can schedule to take the online proctored exam when they are ready at the *Oracle MyLearn* portal. Be sure to schedule for the right exam. Candidates can reschedule an exam without penalty up to 48 hours before the appointment time.

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https://mylearn.oracle.com
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Candidate Agreement

Before taking the exam, candidates will have to agree to the terms and conditions of the *Oracle Certification Program Candidate Agreement* found at this site:

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https://education.oracle.com/file/general/ocp_candidate_agreement.pdf
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After Taking the Exam

After taking the exam, candidates will receive an email from Oracle within 30 minutes informing them that their exam results are available in CertView. Candidates who pass the exam will receive an email informing them that an eCertificate is available in CertView. Instructions for requesting a printed copy of the certificate are included in this email.

Candidates who fail the exam can register to retake the exam after a 14-day waiting period.

A.3 How the Online Proctored Exam Is Conducted

The English-language exam is conducted as an online proctored exam. Comprehensive instructions for the online exam can be found at the *Oracle MyLearn* portal.

Requirements for the Online Proctored Exam

Specific requirements are stipulated at the Oracle MyLearn portal for the computer equipment, required ID proofs, and test space in order to take the online exam. A proctor will ensure that these requirements are met before the exam begins and during the exam.

Well before the exam, it is important that candidates familiarize themselves with and prepare for the exam, including making sure all exam requirements are met. Candidates should consult the Oracle MyLearn portal for the requirements that are in effect at any given time. The following is a short summary of these requirements at the time of writing this book.

- *Computer equipment*
  Minimum requirements are spelled out for computer equipment (personal desktop/laptop) with regard to Internet connectivity, audio, and webcam capabilities. Candidates will need to prepare their equipment in advance so that it meets the minimum requirements.
- *Proof of identity*
  The Oracle MyLearn portal states the exact requirements regarding two forms of government-issued identifications that may be required to take the exam.
- *Testing space*
  Apart from checking in 30 minutes before the exam and taking it in a quiet, distraction-free room, there are strict requirements as to what is *not* allowed during the exam. Considering the mode of exam delivery, these restrictions are not surprising as they create a test space where the only communication allowed is that between the candidate and the exam delivery software.

The Exam Program

The computer program used to conduct the exam will select a set of questions at random, and present them through a graphical user interface. The interface is designed in such a way that candidates are able to move back and forth through the questions for reviewing purposes. Questions can be temporarily left unanswered, and the candidate can

return to them later. The candidate can also mark questions for later review during the exam.

Before the exam starts, the candidate is allowed a test run with the test interface. A demo test that has nothing to do with the Java exam is used. Its sole purpose is to acquaint the candidate with the program being used to conduct the exam.

Utilizing the Allotted Time

The exam consists of a fixed number of questions that must be answered within the allocated time. As candidates have limited time to answer each question, they cannot afford to get stuck on a question. If the answer does not become apparent within a reasonable time, it is advisable to move on to the next question. Time permitting, it is possible to return to the unanswered questions later. It is important to answer *all* questions, however a wrong answer and a blank answer carry the same penalty: loss of points. Therefore, it is better to guess an answer and hope that it is correct rather than leaving blank. The process of elimination can sometimes be useful in narrowing down the answer to a question. Eliminating obvious incorrect choices increases the chances of arriving at the right answer.

An experienced Java programmer used to taking exams should be able to complete the exam within the allotted time. Any remaining time is best used to review one's answers.

The Exam Result

The exam results are presented on the screen after the exam. Afterwards, candidates should log on to the CertView certification portal to see details about their performance:

- An indication of whether they passed or failed.
- The total score. Only the scored questions on the exam contribute to the final score. All the scored questions are weighted equally, and the score is calculated based on the percentage of correct answers. No credit is given for partially correct answers for the scored questions.
- Indications on how well the candidate did on each category within the objectives. Candidates who fail the exam should pay close attention to this information. If the candidate is planning to retake the exam, it may give a good indication of which topics need closer attention.

The result will not divulge which questions were answered correctly.

A.4 The Questions

Assumptions About the Exam Questions

Candidates should be aware of certain assumptions made about the questions on the *Java SE 17 Developer Exam*. In the following list, we provide a short explanation of these assumptions.

- *Missing package and import statements*
  Unless explicitly provided, stated, or referred to in the question, assume that the code is in the same package/module and all necessary import statements are given.
- *No file or directory pathnames for classes*
  In this case, assume that either all classes are in the same file or each class is in a separate file and these files are in the same directory.
- *Unintended line breaks*
  Line breaks that make the code lines appear to be wrapped unintentionally should be ignored, and the code should be assumed to compile without errors.
- *Code fragments*
  Assume that the necessary context exists to compile and execute the code, if such context is not explicitly specified by the question.
- *Descriptive comments*
  Such comments should be taken at their face value, providing the intent described in the comment.

Types of Questions Asked

Most of the questions follow a common format that requires candidates to apply their knowledge in a special way.

- Analyzing program code. The question provides some source code, and asks a specific question pertaining to the code. Will running the program provide the expected result? What will be written to the standard output when the program is run? Will the code compile? Choosing a code snippet to insert in the given code in order for it to exhibit specific behavior.
- Identifying true or false statements.

When analyzing program code, it is useful to try to apply the same rules as the compiler: examining the exact syntax used, rather than making assumptions on what the code tries to accomplish.

The wording of the questions is precise, and the responses selected in multiple-choice questions are likewise expected to be precise. This often causes the test to be perceived as fastidious. Close attention should be paid to the wording of the responses in a multiple-choice question.

None of the questions is intentionally meant to be a trick question. Exam questions have been reviewed by both Java experts and language experts to remove as much ambiguity from their wording as possible.

Since the program used in the exam will select and present the questions in a random fashion, there is no point in trying to guess the form of the questions. The order of the answers in multiple-choice questions has been randomized, and therefore, has no significance.

Types of Answers Expected

All exam questions are multiple choice. The correct number of alternatives to select is designated in the question, and all must be selected for the question as a whole to be considered correctly answered.

There should be no problem identifying which form of answer each question requires. The wording of the questions will indicate this, and the software used will present the candidate with an input method corresponding to the form of answer expected.

For multiple-choice questions, the program will ask the candidate to select a specific number of answers from a list. Where a single correct answer is expected, radio buttons will allow selection of only one answer. The most appropriate response should be selected.

In questions where all appropriate responses should be selected, check boxes will allow the selection of each response individually. In this case, all choices should be considered on their own merits; that is, responses should not be weighed against each other. It can be helpful to think of each of the choices as an individual true–false question.

Topics Covered by the Questions

Topics covered by the exam are basically derived from the set of exam objectives defined by Oracle. Not all topics may appear on an actual exam session, due to the limited number of questions comprising the exam. The objectives for the *Java SE 17* and *11 Developer* exams are included in **Appendix B** and **Appendix C**, respectively, with references to where the topics are covered in the book.

Many of the questions will require intimate knowledge of core Java APIs. This book covers the most important classes and methods of the Java SE Platform API, but it does not go as far as listing every member of every class. The Java SE Platform API documentation should be consulted, as it is essential that candidates familiarize themselves with the relevant parts of the API documentation.

Previous chapter
< 26. Secure Coding

Next chapter
Appendix B. Exam Topics: Java SE 17 Developer >